You can keep working until you save it. Unfortunately, for most of you that means you can forget about very early retirement. The idea is to retire now, with your kids at home, so you can enjoy them while they're young. By the time you have an extra $100,000 to $150,000 per child your kids may be well on their way to starting families of their own.

You can have a heart-to-heart talk with Johnny's grandparents. They may be willing to pay for Johnny's education. The rule in chapter 6 is, "Don't expect a little help from your friends." Friends include family, and it's a safe bet that Johnny's grandpa and grandma would rather see you keep working. But that just means you'll have to work harder to convince them. After all, you want to retire to dedicate more time to your family while the kids are young. Grandpa and Grandma can hardly object to that. And they may already have decided to help Johnny with his education. You're simply asking them to commit the money a bit sooner.

But most of you can't count on your parents to pay for your children's education. Once you retire you'll move to North Carolina or another low-cost state. As a practical matter, you'll send your kids to public schools. When they reach college age they'll go to a public university. How can you make sure they get the best education public money can buy?

PRIMARY AND SECONDARY SCHOOLS

Chapter 4 suggests you spend your next vacation looking for retirement spots in North Carolina, Georgia, Tennessee, or Kentucky. If you prefer, try Texas, Arkansas, New Mexico, and Washington. Check for the right climate, low-cost housing, and things to do. But with kids you need to do more. Once you find a place that strikes your fancy, you need to evaluate the local public schools.